

Analysis

Time Complexity

The method makes one recursive call for each year.

- **Time Complexity:** $O(n)$
- **Space Complexity:** $O(n)$ due to the recursion stack.

where n is the number of forecast years.

How to Optimize the Recursive Solution

```
public static double predictFutureValue(double currentAmount,  
                                       double annualGrowthRate,  
                                       int forecastYears) {  
  
    for (int year = 1; year <= forecastYears; year++) {  
        currentAmount *= (1 + annualGrowthRate);  
    }  
  
    return currentAmount;  
}
```

Recursion simplifies financial forecasting by expressing future value as repeated growth over smaller time periods. The recursive solution has $O(n)$ time complexity and $O(n)$ space complexity. For very large forecasting periods, an iterative approach is preferred because it achieves the same $O(n)$ running time while reducing space complexity to $O(1)$.